

What is Organising in Management?

Organising refers to a process consisting of a series of steps to identify and group various activities, collect or assemble various resources and establish authority relationships with responsibility amongst job positions. It can be mentioned as collecting and utilizing human and non-human resources to implement plans in a highly effective and efficient manner. It is to achieve the overall plan of the organisation. In other words, it refers to the process of arranging people to work together and accomplish a common goal. It is a process of identifying activities to be performed, grouping these activities into work units, assembling tasks for the various job positions, defining rules, and establishing the authority, responsibility, and relationship amongst them.

Definition of Organising

- “Organising is a process of defining and grouping the activities of the enterprise and establishing the authority relationships among them. In performing the organising function, the manager defines, departmentalizes, and assigns activities so that they can be most effectively executed.” –**Theo Haimann**
- “Organizing is a function by which the concern is able to define the role positions, the jobs related and the coordination between authority and responsibility.” – **Chester I. Barnard**
- “Organizing is the process of defining and grouping the activities of the enterprise and establishing the authority relationships among them.” – **Luther Gulick**

Importance of Organising

Following are the importance of organising:

1. Benefits of Specialization:

In an organisation, work is divided into units and departments. This division of work leads to specialization in various activities of the concern. The entire philosophy of the organisation is based on the concept of division of work into compact jobs. This leads to systematic allocation of jobs amongst staff, which enhances productivity and reduces the workload. Division of work refers to assigning responsibility for each organisational component to a specific individual or group. This, in turn leads to specialization, efficiency and speed in job performance.

2. Clarity in a Working Relationship:

After identification of a job, organising also clarifies the authority and responsibility of individuals of different departments. It is a means of creating coordination among different departments of enterprises. It aims at creating clear-cut responsibility, and authority relationships amongst different levels and ensuring cooperation amongst individuals and groups. Harmony of work is brought by the high level of management. Every employee knows his superior from whom he has to take the order, and to whom he has to report. This working relationship helps in fixing responsibility and helps to avoid confusion.

3. Optimum Utilization of Resources:

Organising ensures the optimum utilization of human and material resources. In organising, work is assigned as per skill and knowledge. The clarity in the job in advance of what the employees are supposed to do avoids confusion and motivates employees to put in their best.

4. Adaption to Change:

The process of organising allows an organisation to accommodate changes in a business environment. So the organisation structure is suitably modified and the revision of the job position and relationships plan the way for smooth transactions. Thus, organising provide flexibility and stability to an organisation. It helps an organisation to survive and grow, despite people leaving and joining. It also helps to adapt to changes in technology, new methods of work, etc.

5. Effective Administration:

Organising provides a clear description of the jobs and working relationships. It helps in effective administration by avoiding confusion and duplication of work. Organising also reduces the workload of the top management by delegating authority. As a result, top management is relieved from routine work and can concentrate on the administration of the company.

6. Development of Personnel:

In the process of organising, a managerial person is trained to acquire a wide experience in diverse activities through delegation of authority. Delegation allows manager to reduce their work by assigning future jobs to subordinates. It also gives time to concentrate on important work. The delegation also develops a sense of responsibility in the subordinates and motivates them to do more challenging work.

7. Expansion and Growth:

An organisation's growth is totally dependent on how efficiently and smoothly it works. The organising process creates a favorable condition for expansion and diversification of enterprise by enabling it to deviate from existing norms and take up a new challenge. Organising allows a business enterprise to access more job positions and departments, and even diversifies its product lines. It helps in the expansion and growth of the business.

Steps in the Organising Process

The steps involved in the process of organising are as follows:

1. Identification and Division of Work:

The function of organising starts with the identification of the total work which is to be done to achieve the organisational goal. The work is divided systematically so that each person gets a separate task to perform. This helps to avoid unnecessary duplication and wastage of efforts and facilitates the specialization of efforts and skills.

2. Departmentalisation:

Once the identification and division of work are done. The next step is to combine group-related activities into units and departments. This process of grouping similar and related activities into groups of large independent units or departments is known as departmentalisation. The grouping may be done on the basis of function, product, customer, etc.

3. Assignment of Duty:

After grouping various activities into departments, the next step is necessary to allocate the work of different employees. Duty should be assigned based on the knowledge, qualification, experience, and capability of the individual. There should be a proper match between job requirements and the capabilities of employees.

4. Establishing Reporting Relationship:

After assigning duty, the next step is to clearly define the authority and responsibility of the employees. If two or more person is working together for a common goal, then it is necessary to define the relationship between them in clear terms. There is a need to create a hierarchical structure and help in coordination among various departments.

Nature of Organizing:

Organizing is a fundamental function of management that reflects certain inherent characteristics essential for effective and efficient functioning of an organization. The nature of organizing can be understood through the following key points:

1. Grouping of Activities:

- Organizing involves grouping various activities and tasks into specific roles and departments. This grouping is based on similarities in function, skills, or resources, facilitating coordination and specialization.

2. Establishment of Structure:

- It involves the creation of a formal organizational structure that outlines reporting relationships, roles, and responsibilities. This structure provides a framework for the distribution of authority and coordination of activities.

3. Hierarchy and Authority:

- Organizing establishes a hierarchical structure with clear lines of authority. Each level in the hierarchy has a defined set of responsibilities, and individuals at each level report to those above them.

4. Division of Labor:

- Division of labor is a key aspect of organizing. It involves breaking down tasks into smaller, specialized components to increase efficiency and expertise. Each individual or department focuses on specific functions.

5. Coordination:

- The organizing function is closely linked to coordination. Coordination ensures that activities and efforts across different roles and departments are harmonized to achieve common goals without duplication or conflict.

6. Flexibility:

- While organizing establishes a formal structure, it should also allow for flexibility to adapt to changing circumstances. A balance between structure and flexibility is crucial for organizational adaptability.

7. Optimal Resource Allocation:

- Organizing aims to allocate resources—human, financial, and material—in the most efficient manner. This involves matching resources with tasks and responsibilities to achieve optimal utilization.

8. Efficiency and Productivity:

- The ultimate goal of organizing is to enhance efficiency and productivity. Well-organized structures and processes contribute to streamlined workflows, reduced redundancies, and improved overall performance.

Types of Organizing:

Organizing takes different forms based on the specific needs, objectives, and characteristics of an organization. Here are some common types of organizing:

1. Functional Organization:

- **Description:** Groups individuals based on their specialized functions or expertise (e.g., marketing, finance, human resources).
- **Advantages:** Encourages specialization and expertise in specific areas.

2. Divisional Organization:

- **Description:** Organizes the firm based on product lines, geographical regions, or customer segments.
- **Advantages:** Allows for a focus on specific products or markets, promoting adaptability to diverse needs.

3. Matrix Organization:

- **Description:** Combines functional and divisional structures, creating dual lines of authority.
- **Advantages:** Encourages both functional expertise and product/service focus. Enhances flexibility and communication.

4. Network Organization:

- **Description:** Emphasizes collaboration and outsourcing. Organizations work with external entities to achieve goals.
- **Advantages:** Leverages external expertise and resources, promoting flexibility and cost-effectiveness.

5. Flat Organization:

- **Description:** Has fewer hierarchical levels with broader spans of control, promoting quicker decision-making.
- **Advantages:** Facilitates faster communication, flexibility, and a more collaborative environment.

6. Hierarchical Organization:

- **Description:** Follows a traditional pyramid structure with clear lines of authority and control.
- **Advantages:** Provides clear reporting relationships and authority, ensuring a well-defined chain of command.

7. Team-Based Organization:

- **Description:** Organizes employees into cross-functional teams to work on specific projects or tasks.
- **Advantages:** Encourages collaboration, innovation, and a focus on collective goals.

8. Virtual Organization:

- **Description:** Operates with a geographically dispersed workforce and relies heavily on technology for communication and coordination.
- **Advantages:** Allows for flexibility in hiring, reduces costs associated with physical infrastructure, and promotes global collaboration.

The choice of organizing type depends on factors such as the organization's size, industry, goals, and external environment. Many organizations may employ a combination of these organizing types to meet their specific needs.

Committees play a significant role in facilitating communication, collaboration, and decision-making processes within the organizational structure.

Committees are formed to address specific issues, oversee projects, make decisions, or provide recommendations to the larger organization.

In this article, we will understand a committee's functions, group behaviour, and problems.

What is a Committee?

A committee is a **group of individuals appointed or elected to perform a specific task or function within an organization**. Committees are typically formed to deliberate on particular issues, make recommendations, or take action on behalf of a larger body or organization. They can be **permanent (standing committees)** or **temporary (ad hoc committees)**, depending on their purpose and duration.

"A committee is a group of individuals in an organization who are assigned the task of deliberating on some matter and reporting their conclusions or recommendations to a larger group or to a higher authority." **Stephen P. Robbins**

Functions of Committee

1. **Decision Making:** Committees are often tasked with making decisions on behalf of the organization, whether it's related to policy changes, resource allocation, project approval, or strategic planning.

2. Problem Solving: Committees may be formed to **address specific problems or challenges faced by the organization**. They analyze the issue, gather relevant information, and develop solutions or recommendations to address the problem effectively.

3. Policy Development: Committees are involved in the formulation and review of organizational policies, procedures, and guidelines. They ensure that policies are consistent with organizational objectives, legal requirements, and industry standards.

4. Oversight and Monitoring: Some committees are responsible for overseeing the implementation of organizational initiatives, projects, or programs. They monitor progress, evaluate performance, and provide guidance to ensure that goals are achieved effectively and efficiently.

5. Communication and Coordination: Committees serve as channels for communication and coordination within the organization. They facilitate information sharing, collaboration, and alignment of efforts across different departments or functional areas.

6. Representation: Committees represent various stakeholders within the organization, including employees, departments, management, and external partners. They ensure that diverse perspectives are considered in decision-making processes.

7. Conflict Resolution: Committees may be involved in resolving conflicts or disputes that arise within the organization. They provide a forum for discussing issues, exploring different viewpoints, and reaching consensus-based solutions.